

Align: Goal-Setting FAQs

Defining Your Performance Impact

Q: Are goals required?

A: Yes, **goals are a required** and included in the annual performance review.

Q: Who should create the goals for team members?

A: Goal creation is a collaborative process between employees and managers, but **with our updated approach, goals are now employee-owned**. Employees create their own performance goals based on alignment conversations with their manager, role expectations, team priorities, and business outcomes.

Managers no longer assign or write goals on behalf of employees. Instead, they guide, clarify, and support to ensure goals are aligned, meaningful, and measurable. Personal goals unrelated to performance outcomes are being phased out.

This shift strengthens ownership, trust, and clarity, supports fairer evaluations, even when roles or teams change, and ensures goals remain relevant throughout the year.

Employees enter their finalized goals directly into UKG.

Q: How many goals should an employee have?

A: Employees are recommended to have **at least 3-5 performance goals** and are required to have at least **one development goal**.

Q: How do goals differ from daily tasks and responsibilities?

A: Daily tasks are ongoing responsibilities. **Goals are projects or initiatives that advance team and company priorities** (e.g., new processes, system improvements, cross-functional projects, or software implementations).

Q: When should goals be established?

A: **Goals are usually set in Q1**. **New hires** or transfers should set goals **within 30 days**.

Q: What is a “SMART goal”?

A: A SMART goal is **Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound**.

Q: How often should goal check-ins occur?

A: Goals should be reviewed **at least on a quarterly basis or more frequently**, as required.

Q: How does goal setting fit into the performance management process?

A: Our performance management model includes the following phases: Align, Review, Measure and Reward. **Goal**

setting occurs in the Align phase, ensuring individual goals support team, department, and company goals.

Q: Will all goals be included in an annual performance review?

A: **All active performance and development goals appear in the review**. Personal goals won't be part of the review process, so prioritize Performance and Developmental goals for maximum impact.

Q: Can I update or delete goals throughout the year?

A: **Yes, if priorities shift and a goal is no longer relevant, it can be updated or removed after discussing with your manager**. However, goals that were aligned, communicated, and simply not completed should remain, as they reflect performance.

Q: If an employee with existing goals transferred into a new department, should I delete prior goals?

A: **Consult your HR Business Partner**. They will help determine the right **approach based on transfer timing, prior manager involvement, and whether any goals were already achieved**.

Q: Can goals be long-term/multi-year goals?

A: Goals should fit within the calendar-year performance cycle (January 1–December 31). If a goal spans multiple years, focus on what must be completed by year-end.

Q: Who can I contact for help with goal setting or technical issues in UKG?

A: For support, **connect with your leader or HR Business Partner**. If additional assistance is needed, you can **submit a ticket through UKG HR Help**.

For UKG technical issues, you may also email HRIS@realpage.com.